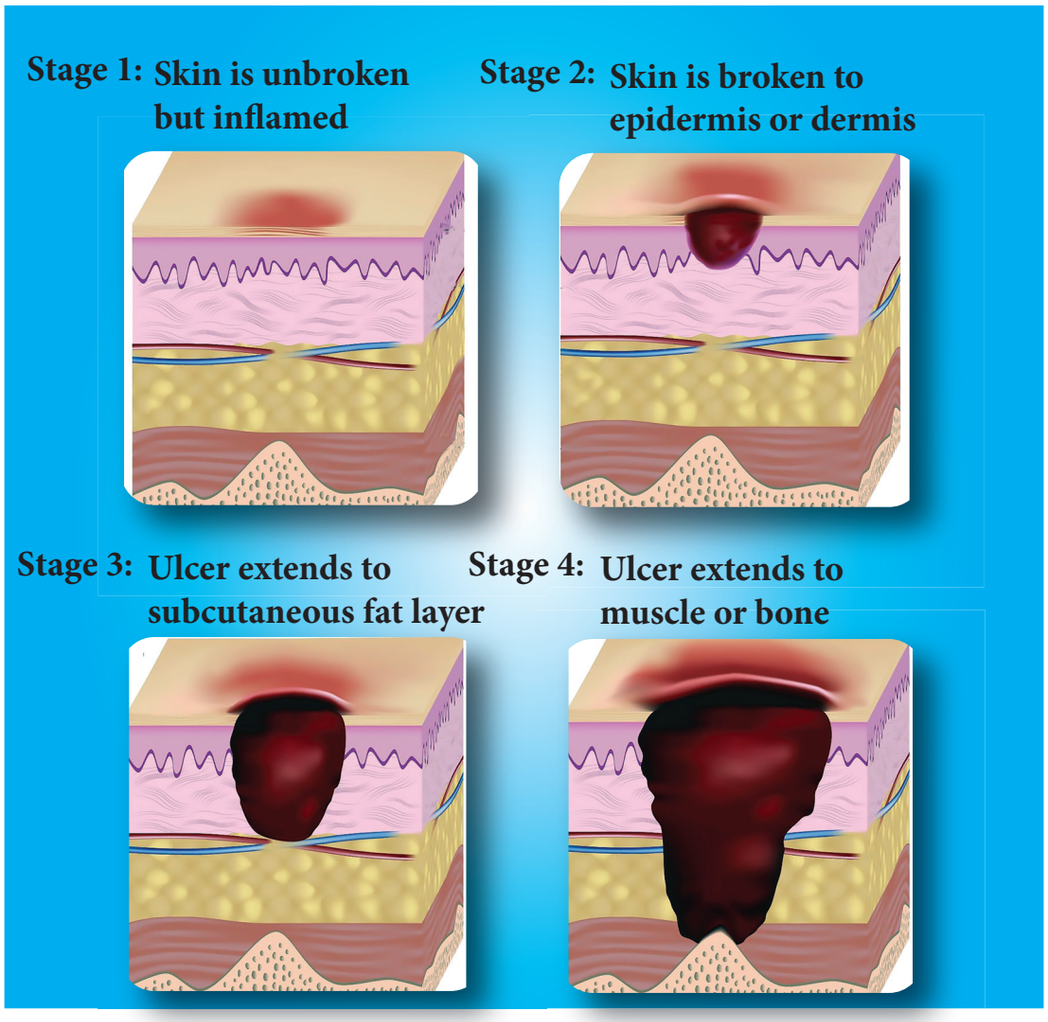


The following steps should be taken:

- **Remove the pressure** from the sore by moving the patient or using foam pads or pillows to prop up parts of the body.
- **Clean the wound**: Minor wounds may be gently washed with water and a mild soap. Open sores need to be cleaned with a saline solution each time the dressing is changed.
- **Control incontinence** as far as possible.
- **Remove dead tissue**: A wound does not heal well if dead or infected tissue is present, so debridement is necessary.
- **Apply dressings**: These protect the wound and accelerate healing. Some dressings help prevent infection by dissolving dead tissue.
- Use oral antibiotic cream: These will help treat an infection.

8.6.7.5 Debridement

Necrotic tissue should be removed in most pressure ulcers. The heel is an exception in many cases when the limb has an inadequate blood supply. Necrotic tissue is an ideal area for bacterial growth, which

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